

## USO DEL DICCIONARIO

Al enfrentarnos a un texto en Inglés intentamos extraer un contenido que está expresado y organizado en un código totalmente distinto a nuestra lengua. Es por eso que para lograr una buena interpretación, no solo el conocimiento de las gramáticas es suficiente, sino también el correcto uso del diccionario bilingüe.

Además, muchas veces encontramos varias palabras desconocidas que a la hora de deducir su significado de contexto o buscarlas en el diccionario no sabemos cómo empezar. Peor aún cuando vemos que una misma palabra tiene varios significados o que puede cumplir varias funciones (verbo, sustantivo...)

Lo primero que deberíamos hacer al encontrarnos con una palabra desconocida es determinar su función teniendo en cuenta su forma y su posición en la oración y luego se deducirá o buscará el significado en el diccionario teniendo en cuenta esa función.

Por ejemplo,

- Estudiemos la palabra KIND en este contexto:

Ejemplo: Many kinds of materials are malleable.

\*su forma termina en S del plural

\*su posición está precedida por un adjetivo =nos indica que es un *sustantivo*

- Busquemos la palabra KIND en el diccionario y encontramos que en su función sustantivo, la palabra significa: “*género, clase, tipo...*”
- En este contexto podemos decir que KIND significa “clase” y por lo tanto que estamos hablando de: *Muchas clases de materiales son maleables.*
- Pero el diccionario también incluye otros significados para la misma palabra. Miremos la palabra KIND en otro contexto.

Ejemplo: He is a kind person.

\*está en posición de *adjetivo*, precediendo a un sustantivo.

La palabra como adjetivo significa: “*bueno, benévolo, manso, afectuoso...*”

En este contexto, KIND significa “amable” y por lo tanto podemos decir que: *El es una persona muy amable.*

Si se intercambian los significados, veremos que los mensajes carecen de sentido:

Muchas amables materiales son maleables.

Él es una persona clase.

## PRÁCTICA

Te proponemos que trabajes con las siguientes palabras y sus significados teniendo en cuenta la función que cumplen en cada oración y su contexto.-

### WORK

- She works as an academic consultant at University. \_\_\_\_\_
- The work is interesting and well-paid. \_\_\_\_\_
- The drier machine doesn't work. \_\_\_\_\_
- You'll have to work hard to pass the exams. \_\_\_\_\_
- He did his post graduate work in mechanics. \_\_\_\_\_
- They put a lot of work in finishing their career. \_\_\_\_\_
- The design of the factory was really a work of art. \_\_\_\_\_
- Because of the crisis, many people are out of work. \_\_\_\_\_
- You can work out the answer by adding all the numbers. \_\_\_\_\_
- The workmen were waiting for a manager's answer in their workplace.  
\_\_\_\_\_

### POWER

- Power is provided by a small 9 volt battery. \_\_\_\_\_
- Many people are opposed to the use of nuclear power. \_\_\_\_\_
- The machine is powered by a solar battery. \_\_\_\_\_
- The current director was in power for more than 5 years. \_\_\_\_\_
- The power of the engine is controlled by pulling the handle in its different positions.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- People should have more power over the decisions the government takes.  
\_\_\_\_\_

### LIGHT

- The light isn't good enough to take the ture. \_\_\_\_\_
- He has some small light duties in the office. \_\_\_\_\_
- She lights her cigarettes with matches. \_\_\_\_\_
- You can carry these light boxes. \_\_\_\_\_
- There was a light knock at the door. \_\_\_\_\_

### FORCE

- The force of explosion blew out all the windows. \_\_\_\_\_
- Somebody tried to get the power lines by force breaking the doors of the compartments. \_\_\_\_\_
- Within a few months, Microsoft became a force to be reckoned within the global software market. \_\_\_\_\_  
The government forced the rebels to surrender. \_\_\_\_\_

## CHARGE

- Electric current is electric charge in motion. \_\_\_\_\_
- The foreign engineer is in charge of this part of the production section.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- If the light is on, the battery isn't charging. \_\_\_\_\_
- Gas charges will rise in July. \_\_\_\_\_
- They have been charged with the results of the investigation on security measures.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- They won't charge for delivery if you pay now. Generally it's free of charge.  
\_\_\_\_\_

## FIRE

- The first step in the process is to fire the engine. \_\_\_\_\_
- Although he was a very good worker, they decided to fire him to reduce cost.
- There is a big fireplace in the house to keep the people warm. \_\_\_\_\_
- The machine was completely destroyed by fire. \_\_\_\_\_
- Police fired on the crowd. \_\_\_\_\_
- 30 people died in a fire in downtown Chicago. \_\_\_\_\_
- Everything in the machine is made with fireproof material. \_\_\_\_\_

## BREAK

- Everyone who rides a bike without helmet is breaking the law.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Bacteria break down the animal waste to form methane gas. \_\_\_\_\_
- An electric circuit is open if there is a break in the flow of electricity.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- The frames are made of plastic and they tend to break easily. \_\_\_\_\_
- In a series of circuits, if one bulb breaks, none of the lights works because the circuit is open. \_\_\_\_\_

## MEAN / MEANS

- The red light means you are running low on fuel. \_\_\_\_\_
- I didn't mean to destroy your plans for next week. \_\_\_\_\_
- The mean of 7, 9 and 14 is 10. \_\_\_\_\_
- It was mean of him not to invite her. \_\_\_\_\_
- He was always mean with his money. \_\_\_\_\_
- We don't have the means to continue with the plant building. \_\_\_\_\_
- The blocks are raised by means of pulleys. \_\_\_\_\_
- Do you know any means of reducing fuel consumption? \_\_\_\_\_